

Recipe by

Plated

Beef Kofta over Turmeric Rice with Spinach, Pine Nuts, and Currants

We can't get enough of sweet, warming *baharat*, a Middle Eastern spice blend that includes cumin, coriander, and cardamom. Here, it seasons seared beef meatballs (called kofta). They're served over fragrant yellow rice that's studded with currants and pine nuts. Now just close your eyes and let these flavors and aromas transport you to the colorful, spice-filled stalls of a bustling bazaar...

3
Servings

40 mins
Total cook time

Intermediate
Skill level

$38.86
$12.95 per serving

Questions?

Main Ingredients

- 3/4 cup jasmine rice
- 1/4 teaspoon ground turmeric
- 1/8 ounce mint
- 1 yellow onion
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1 teaspoon baharat spice
- 1 pound ground beef
- 2 tablespoons pine nuts
- 3 ounces baby spinach
- 3 tablespoons currants
- 5 3/10 oz cups nonfat Greek yogurt
- olive oil
- kosher salt
- black pepper

Cooking Instructions

Step 1

In a small pot, combine **rice**, **turmeric**, **1.25 cups water**, and **.25 teaspoon salt**, and bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 10-12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Meanwhile, rinse all produce. Roughly chop **mint** leaves, discarding stems. Peel **onion** and finely chop. Mince **garlic**.

Step 2

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **onion**; sauté, stirring, until soft, 3 minutes. Add **garlic**; sauté until fragrant, 1 minute more. Remove pan from heat. Transfer **half of aromatics** to a large bowl for kofta; reserve **remainder** in a small bowl for rice. Wipe pan clean for Step 4.

Step 3

To large bowl with aromatics, add **baharat**, **.75 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel and add to bowl. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 9 equal logs, about 1 inch thick. (Try to make your kofta the same width throughout, like sausage—this will help them cook evenly.)

Step 4

Return pan from aromatics to medium-high heat with **2 teaspoons olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **kofta** and sear, flipping occasionally, until almost cooked through, 6 minutes. Scatter **pine nuts** around kofta in pan; continue searing until kofta are browned all over and medium rare and pine nuts are toasted, 2-3 minutes more (see recipe tip). Transfer **kofta** to a plate to rest, leaving pine nuts behind in pan, off heat.

Step 5

Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel. Fluff **turmeric rice** with a fork. To pan with pine nuts, still off heat, stir in **currants**, **turmeric rice**, **spinach**, and **reserved aromatics** (from small bowl) to wilt spinach slightly (see recipe tip). Season with **salt** and **pepper** as desired. To small bowl from aromatics, add **Greek yogurt**, **half of mint**, **2 tablespoons water**, **.25 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired and stir until smooth and pourable.

Step 6

Divide **turmeric rice** among serving plates. Add **mint-yogurt sauce** to plates and top with **beef kofta**. Garnish with **remaining mint** and enjoy!

All recipe ingredients should be cooked to a safe internal temperature according to USDA guidelines. After preparing a recipe, please store any leftovers in the refrigerator.

Questions?